

**DEPARTMENT
POLICY**

Food Assistance Program (FAP) recipients may use their benefits to purchase prepared food in certain authorized restaurants. All group members must be either:

- Elderly (60 years of age or over).
- Disabled (receives disability or blindness payments or receives disability retirement benefits from a governmental agency because of a disability considered permanent).
- Homeless.
- A spouse of a FAP recipient who is eligible for the program.

Food assistance benefits cannot be used at restaurants in border or in other States.

**Eligible
Restaurants**

To be eligible to accept FAP as payment for prepared food, restaurants must meet all the following requirements:

- Have sit-down seating available.

Exception: Unless prohibited by a public health order that would only allow delivery or takeout.

- Be fully accessible to persons with disabilities.
- Have a current food service license.
- Sign an agreement with the Michigan Department of Health and Human Services (MDHHS) to among other things, offer low cost-meals.
- Be authorized by the USDA to participate in the Food Assistance Program as a retailer.
- Have a point-of-sale device for use by eligible recipients.

Eligible recipients have a code on their Bridge card allowing for purchase of prepared food at authorized restaurants.

If the household's circumstances change, such as no longer being homeless, the card is updated accordingly and FAP benefits can no longer be used at a restaurant.

CENTRAL OFFICE RESPONSIBILITIES

Food Assistance Agreements

Central office will process requests from restaurants wishing to accept FAP benefits and approve agreements with those which qualify. Refer restaurants inquiring about the program to: MDHHS-RestaurantMealProgram@michigan.gov.

Information on the program and copies of the restaurant agreement are also available on the MDHHS website.

LOCAL OFFICE RESPONSIBILITIES

Informing the Client

At the group's request, the local office will provide the names and addresses of authorized restaurants that accept FAP as payment for prepared food in their establishments. RFT 262, lists restaurants authorized to accept FAP benefits. A list is also available on the MDHHS website.

LEGAL BASE

7 CFR 278.1

Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program, 42 USC 2011-2036